



ACT/CAPDEV/DCI/TT-1872/SER:NU:

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SUBJECT: **CALLING NOTICE FOR THE 2026 TECHNOLOGY FOR INFORMATION, DECISION, AND EXECUTION SUPERIORITY (TIDE) SPRINT (4-8 MAY 2026)**

DATE: 03 MAR 2026

1. This Calling Notice provides the necessary information to national governments, NATO organizations, industry and academia intending to participate and contribute to the 2026 TIDE Sprint taking place from 4 to 8 May 2026, in Istanbul, Türkiye.

2. **Background.** The Technology for Information, Decision, and Execution Superiority Sprint or TIDE Sprint is one of ACT and NATO's premier events for promoting digital interoperability and innovation. TIDE Sprint aims to rapidly evolve concepts and specifications, improving interoperability among NATO and Partner Nations' command and control capabilities and information technology services. It is part of the ACT Interoperability Continuum, which also includes the TIDE Hackathon and Coalition Warrior Interoperability Exercise.

3. **TIDE Sprint Evolution.** Previous TIDE Sprints were structured in thematic tracks, generally scoped around Communications and Information Technology (CIS), Digital Transformation (DT), Innovation and Emerging and Disruptive Technologies (EDT) like Artificial Intelligence (AI), led by experts from NATO or Nations. Addressing NATO's and HQ SACT's priorities as well as lessons identified from previous iterations, a new TIDE Sprint construct will be tested in 2026. The new format will be driven by ACT leadership's direction and guidance, focusing on clear outputs.

4. **New Format:** The 2026 TIDE Sprint will be structured around two main themes, hereafter referred to as Streams: **Digital Transformation (DT)** and **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**. ACT Staff will coordinate the design and delivery of each Stream, following the schema outlined in Annex A. Based on these work strands, each Stream will orchestrate:

a. One main agenda focused on interactive engagements with the participants, deep dives to specific topics, as required. (e.g. panel discussions, workshops, presentations, etc...).

b. One agenda dedicated primarily to educational content ("DT School" and "AI School") to inform participants and raise awareness of the audience.

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5. **Call for Papers and Contributions.** ACT Staff have already initiated preliminary contacts with potential contributors to support ACT objectives in these areas. Unsolicited contributions may also be submitted no later than 20 March 2026 to the AI and DT stream team:

- a. Digital Transformation Stream: hgsact.dto@nato.int
- b. Artificial intelligence Stream: hgsact.dsai@nato.int

6. **Stream Agendas.** The status of each stream along with its objectives and session content will be available on the [2026 TIDE Sprint](#) Tidepedia page.

7. **Attendance.** Attendance is encouraged from:

- a. Representatives of Alliance and Partners (Interoperability Platform Nations¹).
- b. Representatives of the following NATO organisations; NATO HQ, SHAPE, JFC-BS, JFC-NF, JFC-NP, MARCOM, LANDCOM, AIRCOM, NCISG, HQ SACT, JFTC, JWC, JALLC, JATEC, CMRE, NCI Agency, NAEW, Centres of Excellence.
- c. CWIX national and focus area leads (and their deputies) who are preparing for CWIX 2026.
- d. Representatives from the NATO Industrial Advisory Group (NIAG), or from industry and academia are encouraged to attend provided they are sponsored by the Government of a participating nation, NATO Command, Agency or other NATO body.

8. **Registration:** Registration is available via <https://cvent.me/wl1Am9>. Registration is now open and closes 17 April 2026. 2026 TIDE Sprint is limited to 800 participants and will be administered based on a first come, first served basis. **Late registration is not possible.** By registering participants accept the terms of a mandatory conference fee (details in this Annex B).

9. **Tidepedia Access.** Tidepedia access is recommended for those attending TIDE Sprint. Participants without a Tidepedia account can request one by emailing: tide@act.nato.int. Representatives from industry and academia should seek national or NATO sponsorship to obtain a Tidepedia account.

¹ Interoperability Platform members: Armenia, Australia, Austria, Azerbaijan, Bahrain, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Georgia, Ireland, Japan, Jordan, Kazakhstan, the Republic of Korea, the Republic of Moldova, Mongolia, Morocco, New Zealand, Serbia, Switzerland, Tunisia, Ukraine, and the United Arab Emirates.

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10. **Classification.** The security classification for this event is Unclassified.
11. **Language:** TIDE Sprint will be conducted in English.
12. **Point of Contact:** hqsact.io@nato.int.
(Chair: Mr. Patrick Ratier, Lead Planner: CDR Ray Sanders)

FOR THE SUPREME ALLIED COMMANDER TRANSFORMATION:

MGEN Dominique LUZEUX


Dominique Luzeaux
Major General, FRA A
ACOS Digital Capability & Interoperability (Acting)

ANNEXES:

- A. 2026 TIDE Sprint Stream Overview
- B. Administrative Instructions

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ANNEX A TO
ACT/CAPDEV/DCI/TT-1872/SER:NU
DATED 03 MAR 26

2026 TIDE Sprint Stream Overview

Digital Transformation

1. Digital Transformation is the prime vehicle transforming the way NATO operates to enable, by 2030, the conduct of multi-domain operations, ensure interoperability across all domains, enhance situational awareness, and facilitate political consultation and data-driven decision-making. As a continuous and cross-cutting process, Digital Transformation (DT) activity depends on Allied contributions and a new cooperative paradigm with industry, civil society and academia, including shared data ecosystems. Through TIDE Sprint, we aim to leverage the work of diverse stakeholders within the Digital Transformation community, identifying challenges and opportunities for acceleration, combined with targeted education and training, to drive implementation of all three DT pillars to service the warfighter.

2. ***DT Implementation***

a. ***Understand the new version of the Digital Transformation Implementation Strategy (DTIS) and NATO's DT maturity:*** Identify ways to accelerate NATO DT delivery. Lessons NATO can extract from Nations and Industry. Focus given on certain DTIS Lines of effort, including but not limited to:

- (1) Cloud and Edge Computing
- (2) NATO Command and Control Systems
- (3) Data Governance and Culture
- (4) Data Management and Architecture
- (5) Data Exploitation
- (6) Alliance Digital Workspace

3. ***Human Dimension***

a. ***Dynamic Learning and development (L&D) for the Warfighter of NATO in the digital age:*** Focus on NATO's current activities and way ahead. Examples of Audacious Training and Adaptive Learning.

b. ***Gender Perspective in DT:*** Understand how NATO can incorporate the gender prospective in technological development, including in AI solutions.

- c. **Organizational Change Management Across NATO:** How is NATO supporting the human side of change on digital transformation. Understand the impact to the warfighter.

4. **Technology Dimension**

- a. **Cloud efforts (Beacon Project):** Identify and understand requirements, challenges, best practices on establishing secret-level cloud services and the required accreditation processes.
- b. **Alliance Data Sharing Ecosystem (ADSE):** Understand the possibilities of ADSE, investigate the challenges and catalyze integrated capabilities with rich data and aligned processes. Identify opportunities for next steps and draw synergies.
- c. **Data Centricity and Zero Trust:** Update on the adoption of zero-trust security principles across cloud environments. Implementation challenges to be discussed. Identify complimentary data lifecycle principles.
- d. **Digital Backbone:** Understand vision, opportunities and challenges. Status updates from NATO entities in relevant work stands.
- e. **Enterprise Architecture for Cloud:** Focus on principles to accelerate the cloud adoption across the organization.
- f. **Digital Interoperability:**
 - (1) Verification and Validation: V&V Challenges and Conformance testing platform towards interoperability compliance.
 - (2) Monitoring: Provide better visibility into interoperability performance.
 - (3) Lessons from Ukraine.

Artificial Intelligence

5. At the edge of a transformative era, Artificial Intelligence (AI) stands as a strategic game-changer. It is not merely a technological advance—it is reshaping industries, governance, and defence ecosystems globally. AI offers NATO an unparalleled opportunity to strengthen our collective defence, improve crisis management, and ensure deterrence by revolutionizing decision-making speed, interoperability, and the way we develop and deploy capabilities at scale. Through TIDE Sprint, we aim to harness this potential and build exciting momentum across NATO's stakeholders, combining capability-focused exploration with targeted education and training to translate strategic ambition into concrete, reusable outcomes. The question is not if NATO adopts AI as a fundamental enabler—it's how effectively the Alliance can urgently capitalize on this technology to deliver impactful change.

- a. **AI as a Strategic Game-Changer (WHY):** AI introduces a transformational shift for NATO in an increasingly competitive global environment, amplified by unprecedented U.S. momentum and global competition. It reshapes the character of warfare, decision-making tempo, digital interoperability and Alliance deterrence.
- b. **A Transformation in Speed and Scale (WHAT FOR):** AI enables capabilities beyond human comprehension—analysing, interpreting, and making decisions at speeds and scales beyond traditional human or organizational processes.
 - (1) By accelerating the Observe, Orient, Decide, Act (OODA) loop, AI enhances NATO's ability to respond to complex challenges faster and more effectively than adversaries.
 - (2) Driving multi-domain collaborative autonomy, necessary for fighting at AI speeds in the modern operational environment.
 - (3) Accelerating projects to transform training, wargaming, command and control, and robotics into AI-enabled systems optimized for scale and agility
- c. **Building All domains AI factories (WHAT):** Establishing AI factories as scalable, AI-enabled end-to-end delivery environments spanning data, models, platforms, assurance, and operations, to continuously develop, deploy, and improve AI-enabled capabilities across domains through user-driven iteration, enterprise-level efficiency, and enhanced interoperability across Allies.
- d. **Data-centric architecture (HOW #1):** Scalable, secure, and evolutive powerful platforms that provide interoperability at the level required for actionable data flows and AI agents.
- e. **Continuous improvement operating model for fast delivery (HOW #2):** A new capability with ability to rapidly evolve AI-enabled capabilities for enterprise-wide efficiencies in multi-domain operations.
- f. **Data governance (HOW #3):** Improved data management, curation, metadata tagging, cataloguing, and labelling as foundations for machine learning and trustworthy AI.
- g. **Responsible use of AI (HOW #4):** Full alignment with NATO's principles for the responsible use of AI.
- h. **Talent and AI Literacy (HOW #5):** Developing, attracting, and sustaining AI-relevant skills across the Alliance through education, training, and shared understanding of AI concepts, tools, risks, and opportunities.

- i. **Emerging Technologies (HOW #6):** Accelerating interoperable capability delivery and shared understanding through robotics and autonomous systems, AI-enabled C2, LLMs and agents, red-team AI, strategic foresight tools, quantum technologies, and nation- and industry-driven solutions.

ANNEX B TO
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ADMINISTRATIVE INSTRUCTIONS

1. **Subject:** The administrative details for the 2026 TIDE Sprint are available on [Tidepedia](#) and will continue to develop over time. Participants should stay apprised of Tidepedia updates to ensure they have the most current information. Initial details are listed below for planning purposes.
2. **Location:** The 2026 TIDE Sprint event will take place at the Multi-national Joint Warfare Center (MJWC) located inside the campus of National Defence University (NDU) located at 4th Levent district of Istanbul, Türkiye.
 - a. Address for NDU: Milli Savunma Üniversitesi, Konaklar Mahallesi, Org. İzzettin Aksalur Cd., 34334 Beşiktaş/İstanbul.
 - b. Only NDU Gate No.4 (GPS Position: 41°06'12.5" N - 29°00'41.4" E) is to be used for gaining access to MJWC. Participants will **NOT** be authorized to enter the NDU campus via other gates. Below is the QR code and the location of Gate Number 4

41°06'12.5" North - 29°00'41.4" East



3. **In-Processing:** Will take place Monday May 4th from 0815-1030.
 - a. In-processing at MJWC will take place at the information desk, located near the entrance on the ground floor of the building.
 - b. For timely in-processing, participants should be prepared to provide either a NATO ID Card, or passport to gain entrance.
 - c. Upon the entrance to MJWC Building, participants are to use the main entrance, and they will be directed to Atatürk Hall where they will receive MJWC Admin and Security Instructions Brief.

d. In anticipation of arrival into Türkiye, each participant should hand carry the following as applicable:

- (1) Passport for border-crossing and customs,
- (2) NATO HQ/Military ID Card for military or passport for civilians.
- (3) NATO Travel Order (substitute for visa-in case of NATO personnel).

Note: The MJWC is a Military Establishment. Participants who arrive without registering will not be allowed entry.

4. **Conference Fee:** A mandatory conference fee of 130€ to be paid on site during in-processing and must be paid in Euros. No other form of cash including Turkish Lira nor any other currencies or credit cards will be accepted.

a. Participants must pay the conference fee during in-processing to receive a badge.

b. The conference fee includes access to TIDE Sprint 2026, the secure conference facilities, support, and amenities including daily transportation to and from designated hotels, and coffee breaks.

5. **Accommodation:** Accommodation is available at a variety of hotels throughout Istanbul. Participants must book their rooms individually and it is an individual responsibility to check hotel terms and conditions for the cancellation policy. The following hotels offer a discounted rate for those who make their reservations via booking links and contacts. **They will serve as the main hubs for daily transportation to and from MJWC.**

NOTE: Military Accommodation is **NOT** available for this event.

a. The participants are suggested to consider the traffic intensity and the distance while booking their hotels. Depending on the traffic, it takes around 30 minutes (excluding rush hour) to reach MJWC from the suggested hotels.

b. Please note that prices are **ONLY AVAILABLE** for the participants who make their reservations via POCs and the links indicated below. MJWC does **NOT** take responsibility for the prices at other websites.

6. The RECOMMENDED hotels by MJWC are as follows:

a. **BİLEK HOTEL**

- (1) Location: Büyükdere Cd., No: 33/A, Kağıthane, İstanbul/Türkiye
- (2) Price: Includes breakfast & taxes
 - (a) 110.-€ (Standard Single Room)
 - (b) 120.-€ (Standard Double, Superior Single Room)

(3) All the guests, planning to stay in this hotel should email **BOTH** of the following email addresses and write “**Tide Sprint**” in the subject line to guarantee their reservations:

(a) reservation@bilekistanbul.com

(b) gagirgol@bilekistanbul.com

(4) POC: Ms. Gizem AĞIRGÖL YALÇIN (Reservation Supervisor)
gagirgol@bilekistanbul.com

b. **SHERATON ISTANBUL LEVENT**

(1) Location: Büyükdere Cad., No: 3-4, Kağıthane, İstanbul

(2) Price includes breakfast

(3) Guests are welcome to stay during 01-10 May at this hotel. Guests should make their reservations through this link ([SHERATON ISTANBUL LEVENT](#)) for event pricing.

(4) Please note that, due to the proximity of the event date, the hotel asks the participants to complete the reservation process as early as possible.

(a) **The link will remain active until 24 April 2026.**

(5) POC Ms.Saadet BELGİNAR (Director of Sales)
saadet.belginar@sheraton.com

c. **HILTON İSTANBUL MASLAK**

(1) Location: Büyükdere Cad., No: 233, Maslak, İstanbul.

(2) Guests should make their reservations through this link ([HILTON ISTANBUL MASLAK TIDE SPRINT](#)) for event pricing.

(a) **The link will remain active until 24 April 2026.**

(3) POCs:

(a) Ms. Aysenur KISIKÇILAR (Assis.Group Conference & Banqueting Sales Manager)
aysenur.kisikcilar@hiltonistanbulmaslak.com

(b) Mrs. Nadya İZİK (Director of Business Development)
nadya.izik@hiltonistanbulmaslak.com

d. **WYNDHAM GRAND ISTANBUL LEVENT HOTEL**

(1) Location: Büyükdere Cad., No: 177-183, Şişli, İstanbul/Türkiye

(2) Prices: Prices include breakfast and taxes

(a) 190 € (Single Deluxe Room)

(b) 213 € (Double Deluxe Room)

(3) All the guests, planning to stay in this hotel should email **BOTH** of the following email addresses and write “**Tide Sprint**” in the subject line to guarantee their reservations:

(a) 21@wyndhamgrandevent.com

(b) **The prices will remain active until 17 April 2026.**

(4) POC: 21 Group&Travel Agencies
Sales, 21@wyndhamgrandevent.com

e. **HYATT CENTRIC LEVENT İSTANBUL**

(1) Location: Büyükdere Cd. No:136, 34330 Beşiktaş/İstanbul

(2) Price: Includes breakfast and taxes

(a) 196 € (King-Standard Room)

(3) Those planning to stay in this hotel should email the following email address and write “**Tide Sprint**” in the subject line to guarantee their reservations.

(4) POC: Erdi ÇAKIR (Corporate Sales Manager)
Erdi.cakir@hyatt.com

f. **DELTA HOTELS İSTANBUL LEVENT**

(1) Location: Büyükdere Cad., No: 187, Şişli, İstanbul.

(2) Price Includes breakfast

(3) Guests are welcome to stay during 2-10 May at this hotel. Guests should make their reservations through this link ([DELTA HOTELS İSTANBUL LEVENT TIDE SPRINT](#)) for event pricing.

(a) **The link will remain active until 31 March 2026.**

(4) POC: Ms. Seher YAMAN (Asst. Group & Event Sales Manager)
seher.yaman@deltaby MarriottLevent.com

g. **RENAISSANCE İSTANBUL POLAT HOTEL (BALMUMCU)**

(1) Location: Barbaros Bulvarı, No: 145, Beşiktaş, İstanbul.

(2) Prices includes breakfast

(3) Guests should make their reservations through this link ([RENAISSANCE İSTANBUL POLAT HOTEL \(BALMUMCU\)](#)) for event pricing.

(a) **The link will remain active until 03rd May 2026.**

(4) POCs:

(a) Mrs. Deniz BAKIŞ URFA (Director of Sales)
deniz.bakis@polatholding.com

(b) Miss HAZAL ERKEN (Group & Banquet Assistant Sales Manager) hazal.erken@polatholding.com

h. **LE MERIDIEN İSTANBUL ETILER**

(1) Location: Cengiz Topel Caddesi No: 39, Etiler, Istanbul.

(2) Price includes breakfast

(3) Guests should make their reservations through this link ([LE MERIDIEN ISTANBUL ETILER](#)) for event pricing.

(a) **The link will remain active until 24 April 2026.**

(4) POC: Miss Sevgi DEMİRAY (Sales Supervisor, Group & Events)
sevgi.demiray@lemeridien.com

7. **Travel, Arrival & Transportation**

a. **Airports:**

(1) There are two airports (İstanbul Airport –IST– and Sabiha Gökçen Airport –SAW) in Istanbul. Both airports may be an option, but due to proximity, participants are recommended to travel via İstanbul Airport (IST).

(2) There will be no transportation from/to airport and hotels. Participants can arrange their travel between hotels and airport by bus and/or taxi.

(3) Local bus transportation is available from both airports to main locations.

b. **Istanbul Airport (IST):** It may be an option to use the local bus transportation between accommodation and airport. The shuttle bus service is called “Havaist” and the webpage is <https://www.hava.ist/?lang=en>. The smartphone application “HAVAIST” can also be downloaded. Online tickets can be bought either online or through the application. **However, online tickets are only valid for 72 hours and once bought, cannot be refunded or cancelled.**

(1) The “Havaist” busses are located near the Arrivals section on the -2 (minus two) floor. Shuttle buses labelled “**HVL-9**” head directly to 4th Levent Metro Station which is close to two of the suggested hotels (Bilek Hotel and Sheraton Istanbul Levent) and National Defence University (NDU). The cost of this trip is approximately 430 Turkish Liras (TL).

(2) The timetable from 4th Levent to Istanbul Airport changes, therefore participants are encouraged to check the website or the application for an updated schedule.

c. **Sabiha Gökçen Airport (SAW):** Recommended transportation from SAW is bus No E-3 to reach to 4th Levent District.

8. **Daily transportation:**

a. Bus: On 04th-08th May 2026, bus transportation will ONLY be provided from/to the 8 recommended hotels and MJWC during the event.

b. Bus departure from the hotels in the morning (before the start of the business) will be announced before the event.

c. Departure timing from MJWC to the hotels will be announced during the day.

d. Buses will ONLY use National Defence University (NDU) "Gate No.4" to access MJWC. A staff member will direct the participants to the MJWC Building.

NOTE: Access to NDU and MJWC via personal/rental cars is not allowed. Only the shuttle buses are allowed to enter the base.

(1) Participants are to show their IDs/Badges when asked as well as while boarding on the busses and proceeding through gates/entrances.

e. Participants who prefer to access MJWC on foot without utilizing Shuttle buses are admitted through "Gate No.4" (NDU Entrance) (GPS Position: 41°06'12.5" North - 29°00'41.4" East)

NOTE: MJWC will be open daily during the event starting at 0815



9. **Meals and Ice Breaker**

a. **Meals:** Breakfast and dinner are not served at MJWC. Lunch will be available in the Mess Hall.

(1) Lunch is served on a pay-as-you-go basis. **Lunches will be paid ONLY by cards (CASH NOT ACCEPTED)**, and it is advisable use contactless payments if possible.

b. **An ice breaker will be held Monday May 4th at MJWC between 1700-1900.** The cost to attend the ice breaker is 50€ to be paid on site during in-processing and must be paid in Euros. Attendance is voluntary; however, sign-up is required at time of registration in order to provide MJWC Staff with accurate numbers.

10. **Currency.** The only valid currency in Türkiye is Turkish Lira. Event participants are highly encouraged to bring a credit card during their stay as most venues, including MJWC, do not accept cash.

11. **Dress Code:** The dress code for participants during the conduct of 2026 TIDE Sprint is business casual.

12. **Security.**

a. The MJWC Security Office has the overall responsibility for all security aspects related to MJWC's activity and facilities. The office is also the coordinating authority who is responsible for providing force protection, oversight and enforcing local guard force policies.

(1) Participants are only allowed to access dedicated rooms and floors during the event. Badges can be asked as required for security reasons.

(2) All computers intending to plug into the MJWC network, must be registered in advance.

(3) It is the participants' responsibility to destroy (shred) documents printed.

(4) Follow the voice announcements and information on electronic boards.

13. **Medical.**

a. During the event, non-emergency medical support to all participants at MJWC will be provided by National Defence University (NDU) Healthcare Facility (Polyclinic) (Ext. Number: 1112).

b. There is a first aid room located within MJWC which will be manned with a doctor and a nurse, in addition to medical support provided by NDU.

14. **Miscellaneous**

a. Smoking is NOT permitted inside the MJWC building. Smoking areas are designated outside the building.

b. Fire alarms are always active. In case of emergency, fire exits are shown on the floor layouts.

c. Changing rooms are available to participants and can be accessed by following the respective signs.

d. **Electrical equipment adapter:** MJWC uses the European standard 2-pin 220V 50/60 Hz electrical supply.

e. Help Desk / CIS Support will be available for additional requirements.

15. **Türkiye Point of Contact**

a. **Ms. Pinar ERAY**

(1) MJWC Real Life Support Planner, pinar.eray@mjwc.tsk.tr